

Ministry of Water, Land and Resource Stewardship

High Streamflow Advisory – South Coast, Vancouver Island

Issued: 9:30 AM September 26, 2025

The River Forecast Centre is **issuing a High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- South Coast including Sunshine Coast, Howe Sound, Sea-to-Sky, North Shore Mountains, Metro Vancouver
- Vancouver Island

*****NOTE: The ongoing job action by the B.C. General Employees' Union (BCGEU) and the Professional Employees Association (PEA) has affected River Forecast Centre (RFC) data systems and work processes. Due to these impacts, RFC staff are unable to access the full range of information that is typically used to generate forecasts and advisories. As a result, current forecasts have a higher degree of uncertainty and should be interpreted with caution.*****

Weather Synopsis:

A strong storm system currently impacting the North and Central Coast is drifting southward along the B.C. coast. Rain will begin impacting Vancouver Island mid-day Friday and reach the South Coast by the evening. The first pulse of rainfall likely switches to showers by late Saturday with the highest totals forecast for the west-facing slopes on Vancouver Island with up to 100 mm precipitation. An additional storm system arrives on Vancouver Island on Sunday and continues into Monday, especially for the South Coast. Currently, the cumulative rainfall for the four-day event has lowland areas of Vancouver Island and the Lower Mainland ranging from 40 to 70 mm. These totals are subject to change based on updated weather models.

River Conditions:

Many rivers on Vancouver Island and the South Coast remain below normal for this time of year due to drought conditions. It's unlikely the incoming storm system will bring heavy enough precipitation to cause widespread flooding on Vancouver Island or South Coast rivers. Rivers are expected to rise rapidly beginning Friday and continue through Saturday in response to rainfall. Rivers are expected to recede before the second storm event increases flows again Sunday and into Monday. The first heavy rainfall event of the fall season for coastal watersheds historically has a subdued response due to low baseflow conditions and drier soils. While rainfall totals may not be high enough for specific flood concerns, high flows and rapid rises in rivers can pose a hazard for road washouts and public safety for recreationalists.

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The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

For information on how to prepare for flood hazards, visit [PreparedBC](#).

BC River Forecast Centre

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A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Fast-flowing bodies of water increase risk to life safety. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.